



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING
Monday, May 6, 2024, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, May 6, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM

Present: Maureen Dempsey, Chair; Susan Bronstein (by remote access)

Absent: Scott Johndrow

Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.

Public Presentation – Digital Equity Planning

The Selectboard received a presentation from Jennifer Nelson and Janelle Franklin, representatives from VHB, who are pursuing a Digital Equity Plan for the town.

Ms. Nelson and Ms. Franklin discussed the general project, including surveys, and other means of collecting information, in order to help the town better understand barriers to internet access, reliability, and affordability.

The Town will use the data to accurately verify federal broadband maps which are used to provide internet funding to unserved households. The goal is to ensure all Westhampton residents, businesses, and institutions can access and afford reliable internet. Mr. Finn, Ms. Bronstein and Ms. Teri Anderson noted that they were assisting with the process.

Board members asked questions, and offered comments and suggestions.

The presenters were thanked for their time and work on behalf of the Town.

Discussion – COPS Grant

Present: Police Chief David White, Police Sergeant Jeff Fish.

The board engaged in discussion in regard to whether the town should pursue an application for a COPS grant, in order to help the town more easily hire full time police officers.

After considerable discussion, the matter was tabled until the Police Chief could confirm the maximum grant amount and other significant terms.

Town Meeting Preview

Present: Ben Warrant, Moderator; Tad Weiss, Chair, and Marilyn Witherell (Finance Committee)

The warrant as published, and a guide presenting proposed motions, amounts, and narratives were reviewed and discussed.

There was extensive discussion about possible outcomes, and alternatives in case of unexpected changes.

All materials were reviewed, changes made, and authorization made to move forward.

Department Reports

Mr. Steve Holt provided an update regarding potential awnings over doors at the public safety complex. ARPA funding is requested.

Initial estimates \$11,530, with a reduction to the estimate anticipated.

Mr. Holt will likely return with a revised estimate to the next Selectboard Meeting.

Administrative Business

Second Reading – ADA Grievance Procedure.

A draft ADA Grievance Procedure was reviewed. No action requested or taken.

Review Correspondence

Correspondence was reviewed. No action requested or taken.

Review and Sign: Payroll and A/P Warrants:

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Dempsey

To approve AP Warrant #W24-23 and Payroll Warrant WP24-23 as presented.

There was some discussion relative to the purchase of plate compactor by the Highway Department.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (9:20 PM)

Review and Sign: Minutes from Previous Meetings

The minutes of April 24, 2024 were reviewed.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Dempsey

To approve the minutes as presented.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (9:21 PM)

Set date for Next Meetings

Upcoming meetings and events:

- May 20, 2024, 7 PM
- June 4, 7 PM.
- The Selectboard will attend Town Meeting on May 11, starting at 9 AM.
- The Board agreed to meet at 8:15 AM on the day of Town Meeting, in order to coordinate which member will present which article.
- Town Election will be on June 1, 2024, 8 AM to 12 Noon

Adjournment

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Dempsey

To adjourn.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0 (9:24 PM)

Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on May 20, 2024.


Maureen Dempsey


Scott Johndrow


Susan Bronstein